



CMHS: Blood and Body Fluids Management and Cleaning SOP

Scope

Site	Department, division or operational area	Applicable to
Community Mental Health Service (CMHS) Midland, Bentley, City East	Mental Health Division	Medical, Nursing, Allied Health, Patient Support Services (PSS)

Purpose

This standard operational procedure (SOP) outlines steps to be followed in order to manage blood and body fluid spills within the relevant CMHS.

Links to relevant documents

- Occupational Exposure to Blood / Body Fluids Management SOP
- [RPBG Patient Support Services \(PSS\) Procedures Manual](#).

General information/preamble

The spill kit is used if blood and other body fluids occur and is located in areas where spills are most likely to occur.

Occupational Health and Safety representative(s) for the area affected may be involved in the process.

Risk

- There is increased risk of exposure to blood borne viruses to patients, visitors and staff if blood or body fluid spills are not managed appropriately.

Key Points

- Standard precautions are to be implemented
- The bulk of the spill needs to be removed before the area can be cleaned
- All staff:
 - are responsible for the first clean of blood and body substances
 - perform the final clean after the bulk has been removed in patient care areas, and the full clean of public areas regardless of the nature of the spill.

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Procedure details

Steps

Pre-clean up

- Alert others to the spill, isolate the area and place wet area/hazard signage
- Perform hand hygiene pre and post clean up
- Put on appropriate gloves and personal protective equipment (PPE). Ensure waterproof dressings on cuts are covered correctly
- Collect Spill Bucket Kit
- Use Spill Mat or Safe-sorb over and around entire area of fluid/spill, if required. When the spill has been absorbed, use a 'bluey' to gather material and place into waste disposal
- Assess spill surface to determine if a disposable microfibre cloth or mop will be required
- Fill 1 L dispenser bottle with 1 L water and 1 Chlor-clean tablet¹
- Use Stride Citrus detergent/Chlor-Clean (general purpose disinfectant) as per instructions and leave to dry, as required
- Place five (5) disposable microfibre mops in charging bucket, pour 350 mL of Chlor-Clean over mops (repeat as required)
 - Close charging bucket lid, wait for 10 minutes then open charging bucket
 - Place microfibre mop frame into charging bucket and push down to attach the disposable microfibre mop
- Ensure floor/surface is clean
- Remove microfibre cloths/disposable mop head and place in rubbish bag and in allocated area for disposal
- Remove and dispose of gloves/PPE
- Remove 'Wet Floor' sign when floor is dry
- Store all equipment safely in allocated storage area after use.

For further instructions refer to the BHS or RPH PSS Cleaners' Manuals^{1,2}.

Solid/non-absorbent surfaces

- Minimise traffic around the spill area and display wet area signage
- Check to ensure there are no sharps or broken glass. If there are sharps in the spill, collect the sharps container and remove the sharps from the spill using forceps
- Confine and contain by covering the spill with Spill Mat or Safe-sorb /paper towels/ disposable absorbent material to absorb the bulk of the blood or body fluid substance and gather with a 'bluey'/dispose once fluid/spill has been absorbed. Large spills may require the use of absorbent granular clumping agent. Use a scoop to remove the absorbed material
- All liquid waste should be double bagged
- Discard all contaminated disposable items into sealed leak proof bag before discarding in general waste. This is appropriate for any partially soiled items or those that have dried blood on them. Items saturated with blood and/or body fluids are to be placed into clinical waste
- Clean area with Stride Citrus cleaner/detergent
- Use microfibre cleaning cloth (dampen with Chlor-Clean) or microfibre mop to clean/mop at the outer edge and work towards the centre of the spill. Leave to dry. Replace microfibre cloth/ microfibre mop often to remove the debris and fluid
- Remove microfibre mop head/cloth and place in rubbish bag (no rinsing required)
- Remove PPE/gloves and discard disposable equipment
- Perform hand hygiene
- Replace any equipment used from spill kit
- Record in the consumer's medical record if appropriate.

Carpet/fabric surfaces

- Blood and body fluid spills on carpeted areas require the use of an absorbent granular product
- Arrange for carpet to be shampooed with an industrial carpet cleaner as soon as possible
- Remove soft furnishing from general use for professional cleaning if appropriate
- If the item is unable to be cleaned satisfactorily then it should be discarded.

Report incident

Staff member identifying a spill must report the incident to manager and complete a [Datix Clinical Incident Management System \(CIMS\)](#) and/or a [Combined Hazard or Incident Reporting \(Choir\) Online Form](#).

Equipment

The equipment required will vary depending on the size, nature and location of the spill.

The following items may be required:

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

A number of plastic boxes of PPE will be available on site which are clearly marked PPE – refer to appropriate Team Leader/Nurse Unit Manager (NUM) for specific locations.

These boxes contain:

- gloves
- aprons
- protective shoes
- protective glasses/face mask
- paper towels.

Spill Kit

Spill Bucket Kits will be available on site - refer to appropriate Team Leader/NUM for specific locations.

They will contain:

- 1 microfibre charging bucket (yellow)
- micro-fibre disposable mops
- microfibre mop handle (yellow)
- 1 bottle Stride Citrus multipurpose cleaner/detergent
- 1L dispenser bottle
- 1 Spill Mat or Safe-sorb & 'Bluey'
- Chlor-Clean (General purpose disinfectant)
- absorbent clumping agent
- heavy duty bags
- forceps and sharp container
- absorbent paper towels
- microfibre disposable cloths
- floor signage
- long disposable gloves
- plastic apron
- if large spill, utilise shoe protection i.e. covers or rubber boots.

Compliance monitoring

Monitoring of Combined Hazard or Incident Report (CHoIR) and Datix Clinical Incident Management System (CIMS).

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References

1. Government of Western Australia. Bentley Health Service Patient Support Services Cleaners' Manual. (2018). Royal Perth Bentley Group, East Metropolitan Health Service. Perth. Australia.
2. Government of Western Australia. Royal Perth Hospital Patient Support Services Cleaners' Manual. (2021). Royal Perth Bentley Group, East Metropolitan Health Service. Perth. Australia.

Related policies, practice standards, clinical guidelines

[RPBG Policy Hub](#)

- Cleaning and Disinfection of Hospital Premises Policy
- Occupational Exposure to Blood / Body Fluids Management SOP
- Healthcare Worker Immunisation and Health Policy
- Pharmaceutical Waste and Blood Products Management Policy
- [Combine Hazard or Incident Reporting \(CHoIR\)](#).

[EMHS Policy Hub](#)

- Personal Protective Equipment Policy
- Waste Management Policy
- Immunisation for Health Care Workers Policy.

[Department of Health Policy Hub](#)

- [Code of practice for clinical and related waste management \(health.wa.gov.au\)](#).

Other

- Environmental Protection Controlled Waste Regulations (2004)
- Occupational Safety and Health Act 1984
- RPH Patient Support Services Cleaners' Manual.

Related National Standards

ACSQHC NSQHS Standards 2nd Edition (2021): Standard 3: Preventing and Controlling Infection; Standard 7: Blood Management.

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